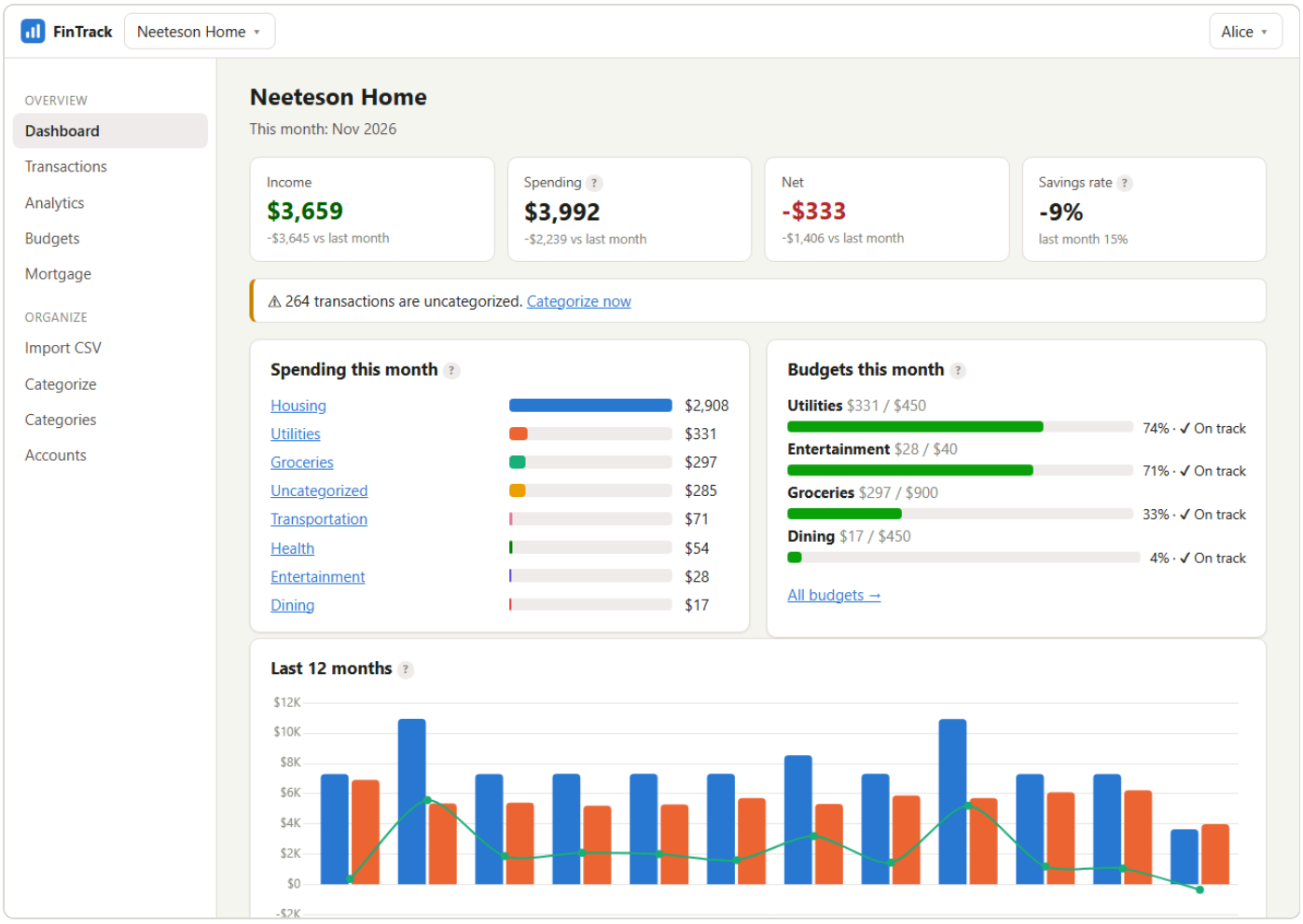
FinTrack

User Manual: household finances on your home network



Version 0.2. FinTrack runs on your own server and never connects to the internet. Everyone in the house signs in with their own account.

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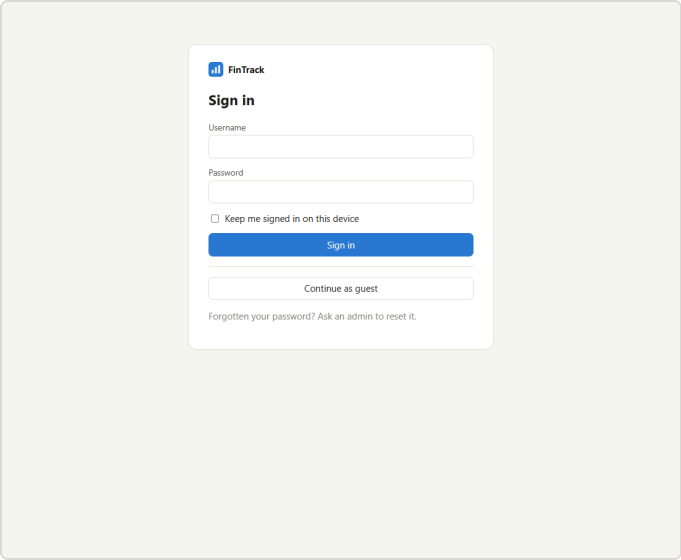
Part I
Using FinTrack

For everyone in the house: importing statements, categorizing, and understanding where the money goes.

1. Welcome and signing in

FinTrack keeps track of a household's money. It reads the CSV files your bank lets you download, sorts each transaction into a category using rules you set up once, and shows where money comes from and goes: per week, month, quarter or year. It also tracks budgets and a mortgage.

FinTrack runs on a computer in your home (the "server") and you use it in a web browser on any computer or phone on your home network, typically at an address like `https://miniserver.local/finances`. Nothing is sent to the internet.



Signing in

Signing in

1. Open the address your admin gave you.
2. Enter your username and password. Tick **Keep me signed in** on your own devices only.
3. The first time, you sign in with a temporary password and are asked to choose your own (at least 8 characters).

Forgotten your password? Ask an admin to reset it; you'll get a new temporary one.

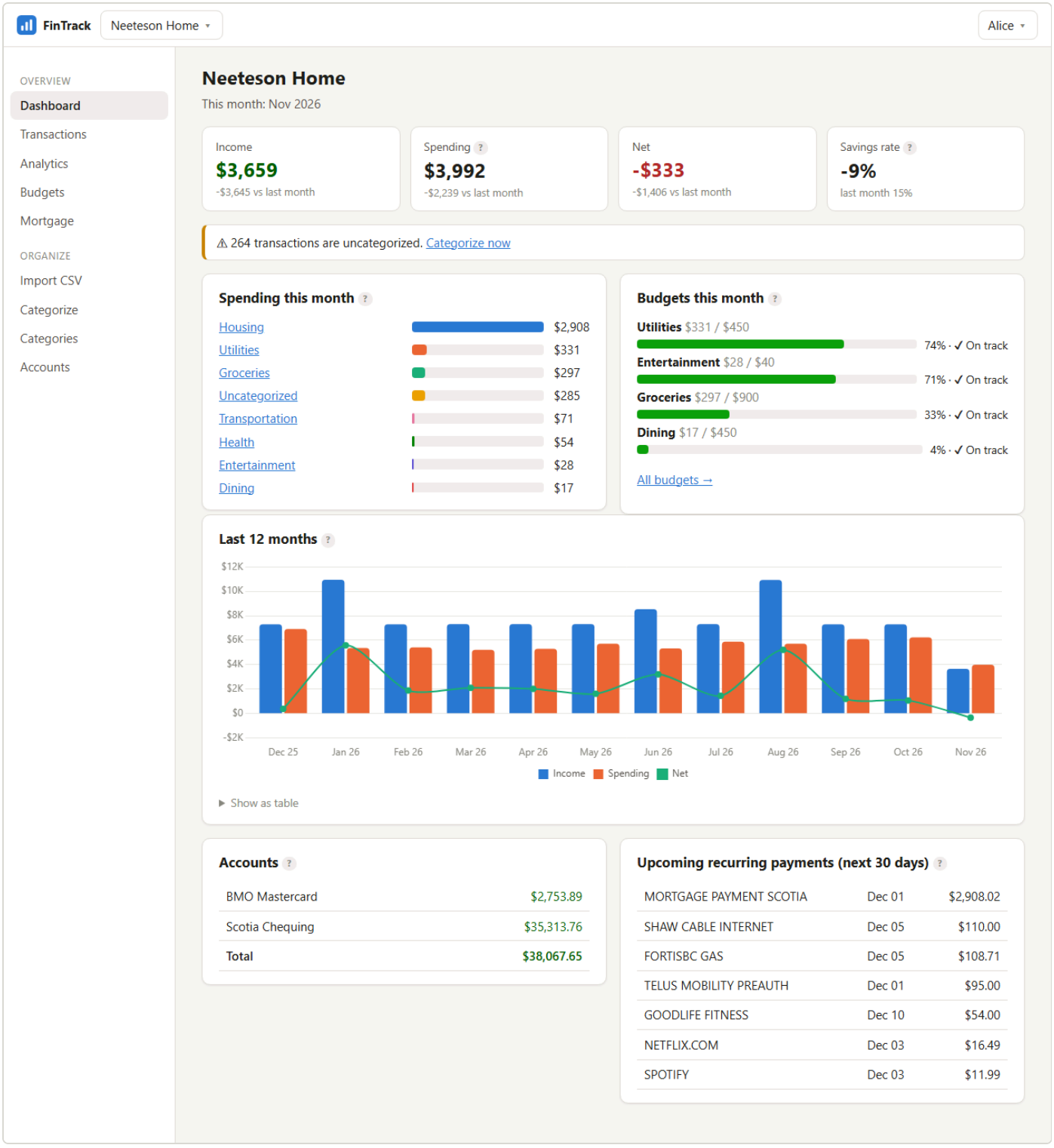
Visiting? If an admin has turned on guest access, the sign-in page has a **Continue as guest** button. No account is needed, and you see only what the admin allows guests to see.

> **Tip** After several wrong passwords FinTrack makes you wait a little before trying again. That protects everyone's accounts.

Households

A **household** is one complete set of finances: its own accounts, transactions, categories, rules, budgets and mortgage. Most homes have one, but you might keep a separate one for a cottage or a small business. Your admin decides which households you can open, and whether you can **view only** or also **edit**.

2. Finding your way around



The top bar, the household menu on the left and the page in the middle.

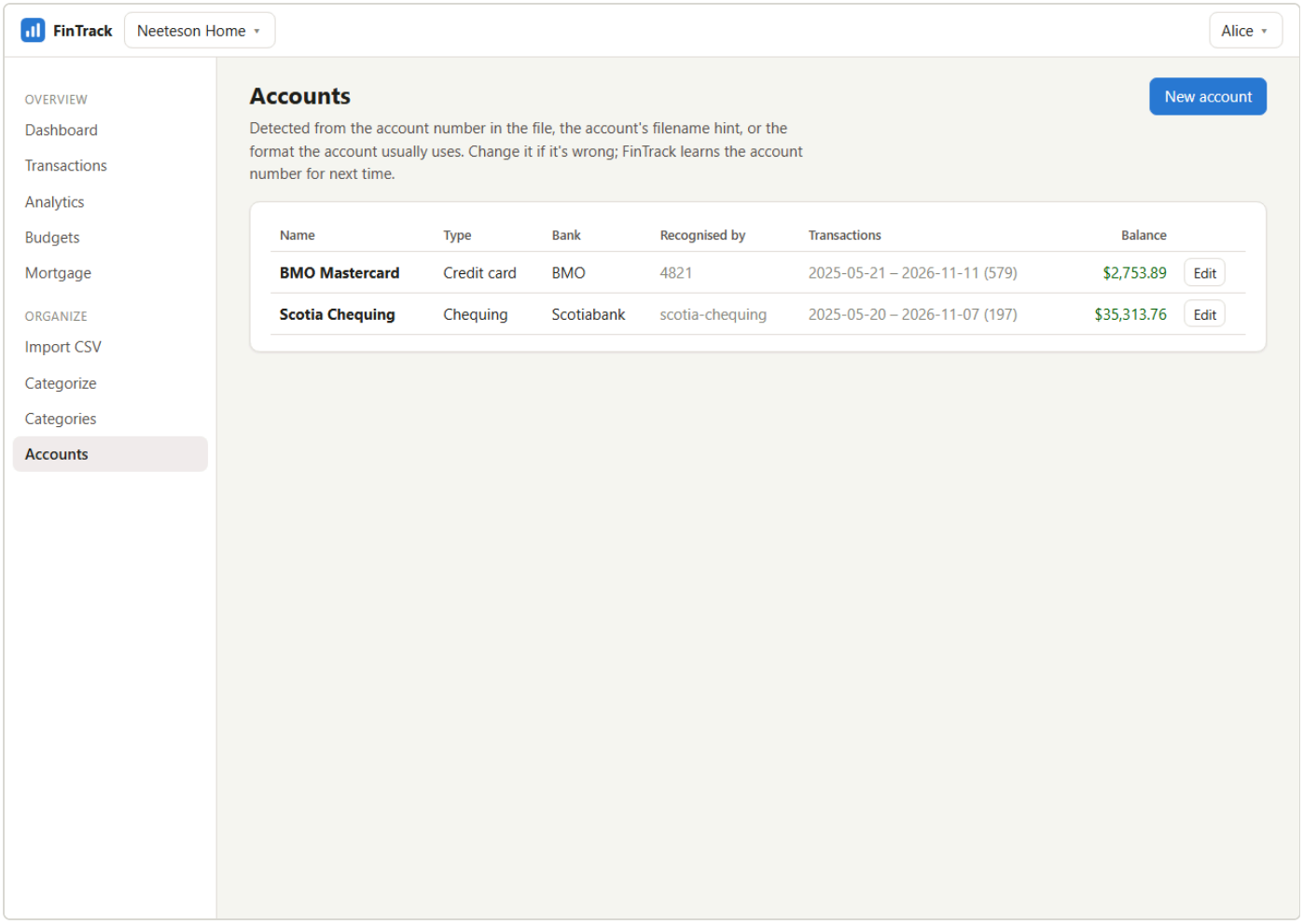
- **Top bar:** the FinTrack logo returns to your household. The **household switcher** (next to the logo) lists every household you can open. The menu with your name has *My account*, *Help*, *Sign out* and, for admins, the admin pages.

- **Side menu:** *Overview* pages (Dashboard, Transactions, Analytics, Budgets, Mortgage) and *Organize* pages (Import CSV, Categorize, Categories, Accounts). Import CSV only appears if you can edit.
- **Help everywhere:** hover over or tab to any small **?** for an explanation of that control. The full guide is under *Help*.
- **Links you can share:** filters live in the page address, so a filtered transaction list or an analytics view can be bookmarked or sent to someone else in the house.

> **View only?** You see the same pages, but without buttons that change anything. If you need to import or categorize, ask an admin for edit access.

3. Accounts

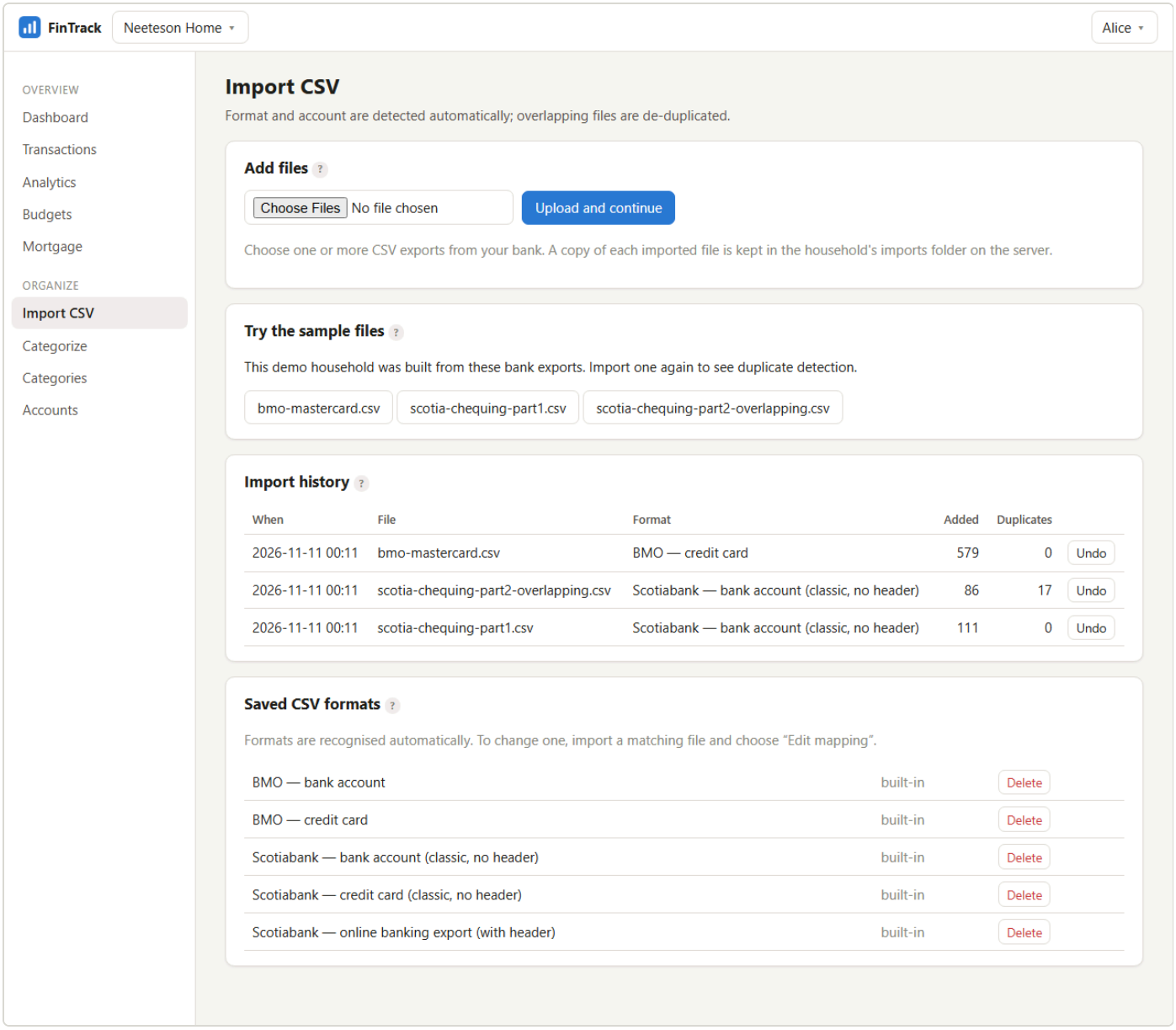
An account is a bank account, credit card or line of credit whose statements you import. You can create accounts on the **Accounts** page, or on the fly while importing.



Field	What it's for
Account number	Full number or at least the last 4 digits. Matched against account-number columns in CSV files; masked numbers such as 5191****1234 work.
Filename hint	Text that appears in this account's export file names (e.g. `visa`). Used when the file has no account number.
Usual CSV format	If only this account uses a format, files in that format go to this account automatically. Filled in for you after the first import.
Opening balance	The balance just before the first imported transaction, so balances and net worth are right. Use a negative number for money owed on a card.
Archived	Hides the account from pickers and the dashboard but keeps its history.

4. Importing bank CSV files

1. In your online banking, download transactions as **CSV** (sometimes called "spreadsheet" or "Excel CSV").
2. In FinTrack open **Import CSV**, choose one or more files and click **Upload and continue**.
3. If FinTrack recognises the format, you go straight to the review. If not, you map the columns once (next chapter).
4. On the review page check the **account** for each group of rows. FinTrack picks it from the account number in the file, the filename hint, or the account that normally uses the format, and says *(detected automatically)*. To use a new account, open *Create a new account for these rows*.
5. Each group shows how many rows are **new** and how many are **already imported**. Expand *Preview rows* to see each row's status.
6. Click **Import N new transactions**. Your rules categorize them straight away. If you uploaded several files, continue with **Next file**.



The Import page with the upload form, the history and the saved formats.

Overlapping files are safe

A row is a **duplicate** when the account already has a transaction with the same date, amount and description. So you can download "the last 90 days" every month and import it without double counting. Two identical rows *within* one file, like two coffees on the same day, are both kept because they are genuinely separate purchases.

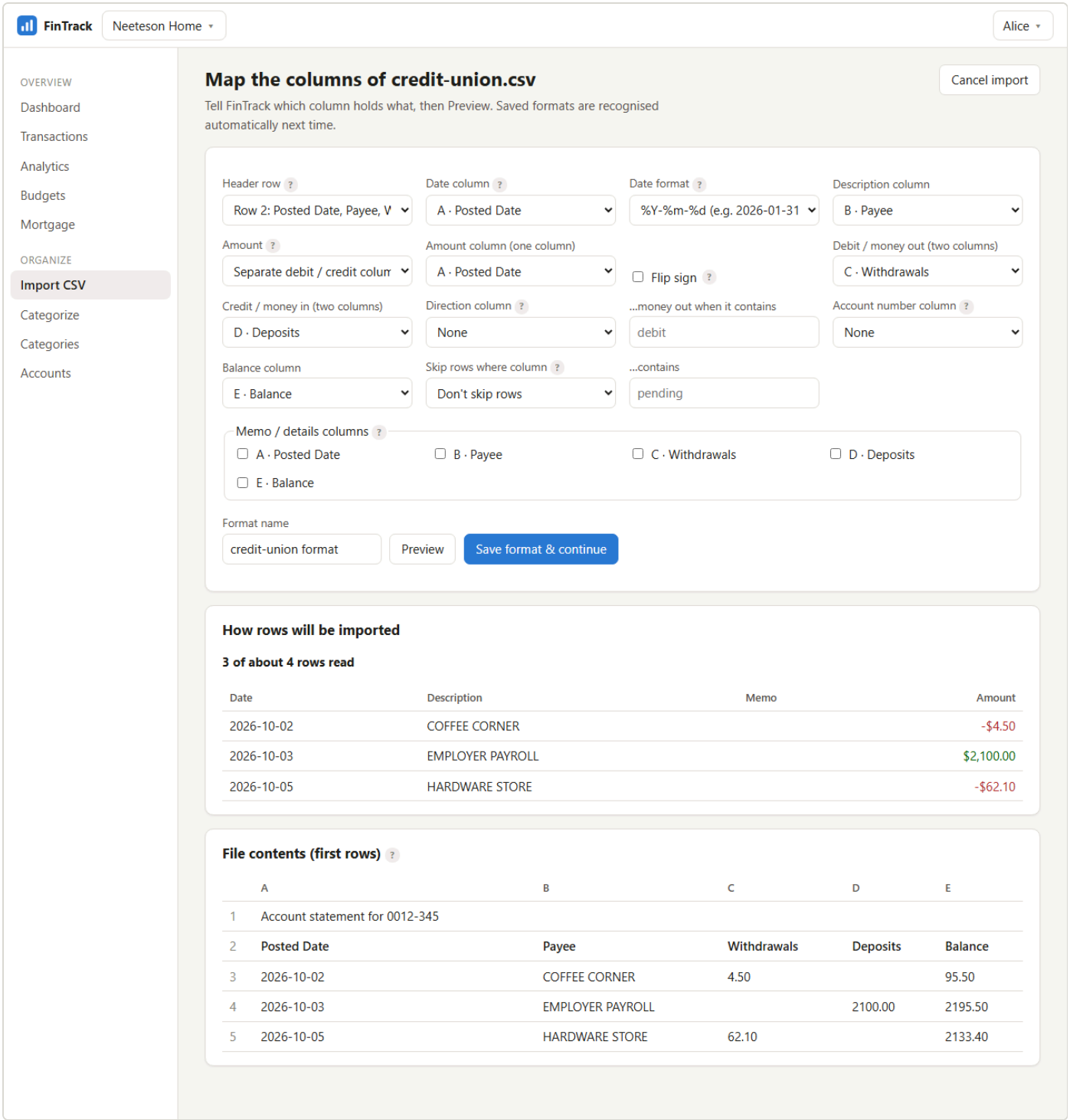
Undo

Import history lists every import. **Undo** deletes all the transactions that import added (manual categories and notes on them are lost).

> **Demo households** have a *Try the sample files* card. Importing one of them again shows duplicate detection: every row is already there.

5. Mapping a new CSV format

Banks lay out their CSV files differently. The first time FinTrack sees an unfamiliar layout it guesses which column is which and shows the **column mapper**. You only do this once per layout; afterwards the format is recognised automatically.



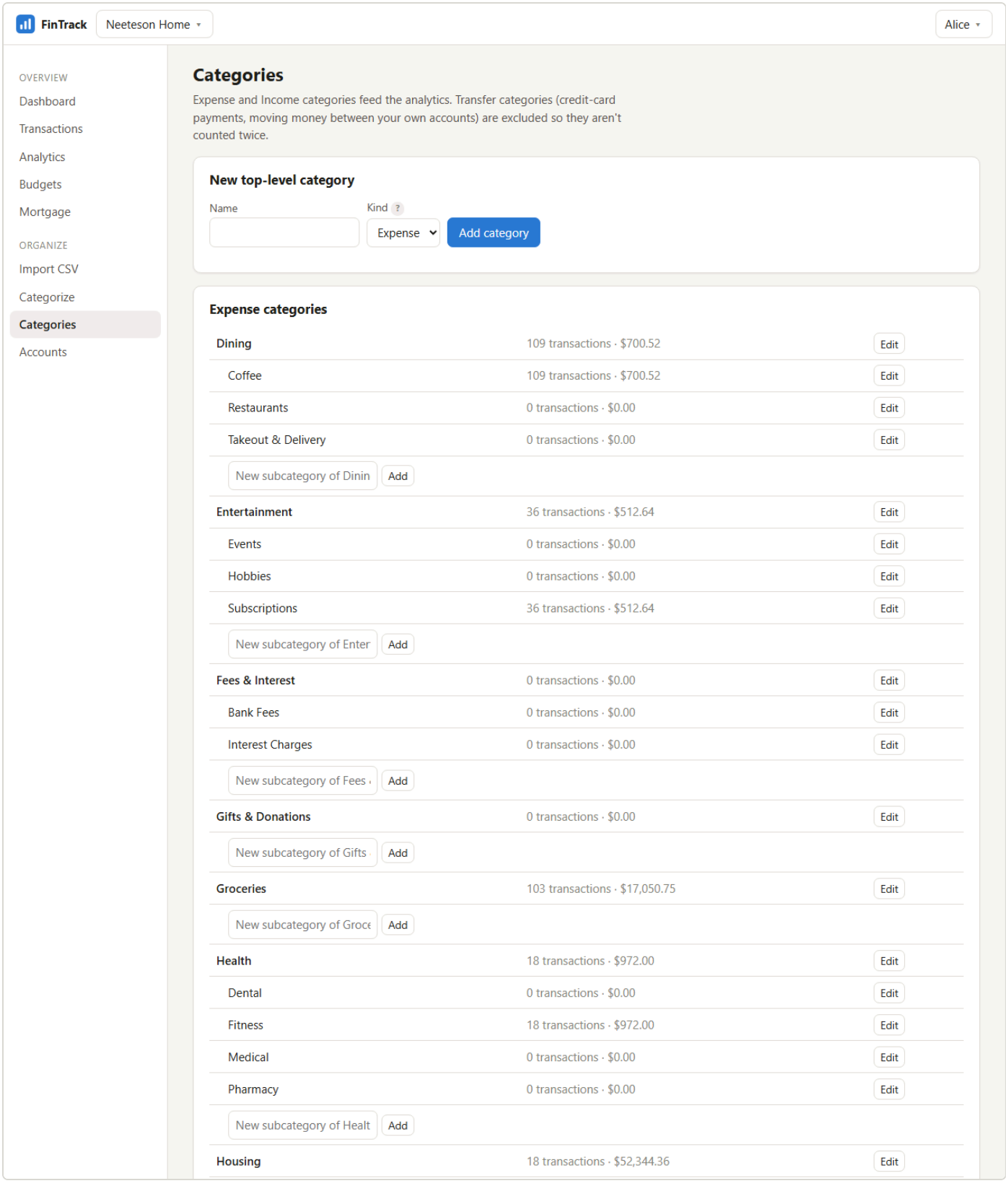
- **Header row:** the row with column names. Rows above it (bank preambles) are ignored. Choose *No header row* if the file starts with data.

- **Date column and format:** *Automatic* tries common formats. Pick one explicitly if day and month could be confused (01/02/2026).
- **Description** and optional **memo / details** columns (searchable; rules can match them).
- **Amount:** one signed column, or separate debit (money out) and credit (money in) columns. Tick **Flip sign** if money out appears as positive numbers (common on credit cards).
- Optional: a **direction column** ("Debit"/"Credit"), an **account number column**, a **balance column**, and **skip rows** containing some text (e.g. *Pending*).

The preview below the form shows exactly how the rows will be read and updates as you change the mapping. Give the format a name, then **Save format & continue**. To change a saved format later, import a matching file and choose **Edit mapping** on the review page.

6. Categories

Categories have two levels: a **top-level category** (Groceries, Housing, Income) and optional **subcategories** (Groceries / Save on Foods, Income / Mayfair). A transaction can be in either level; reports can group by either.



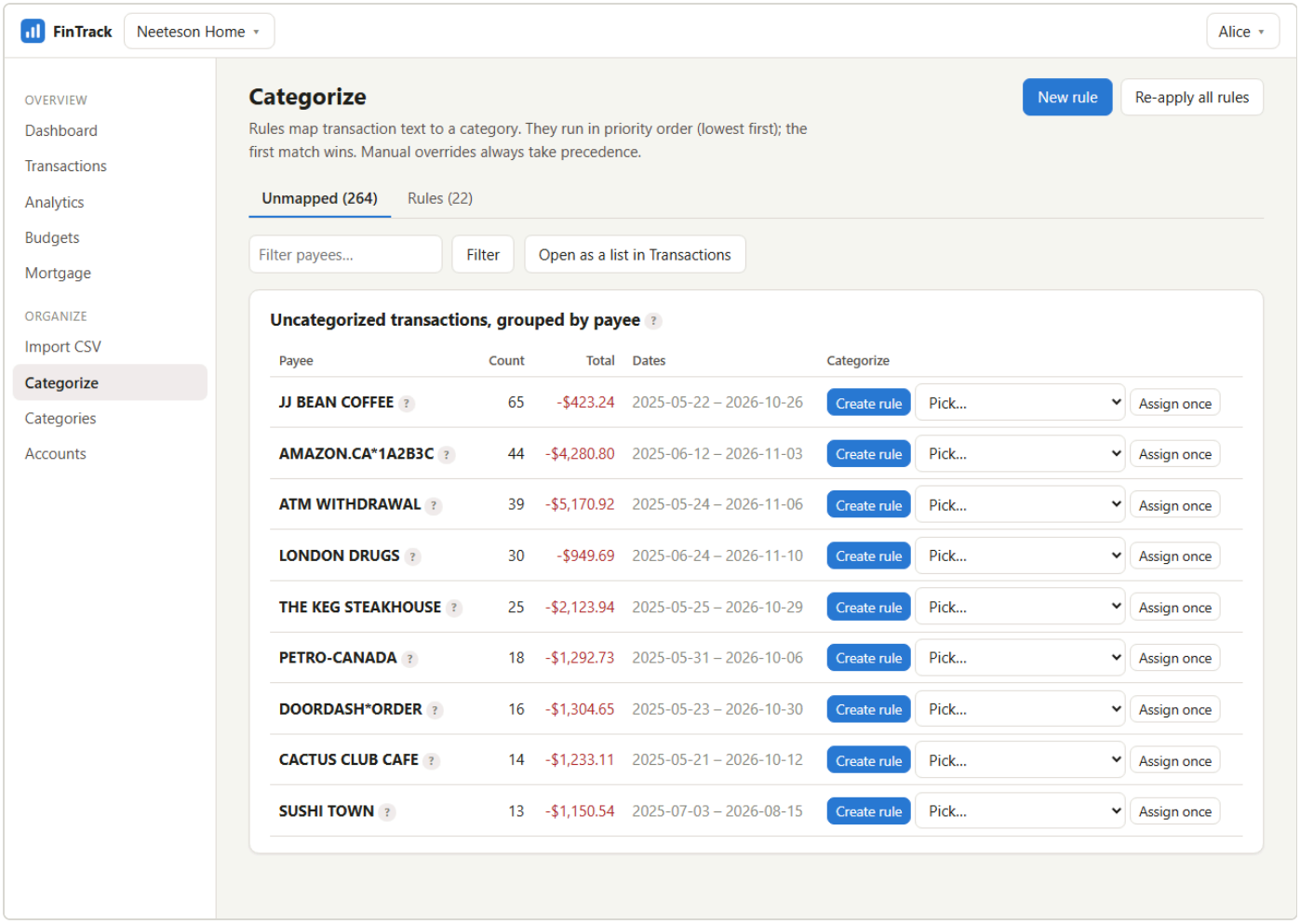
Each top-level category has a **kind**:

- **Expense** and **Income** feed the reports.
- **Transfer** is for money moving between your own accounts (paying the credit card, savings contributions). Transfers are left out of income and spending so nothing is counted twice.

Add subcategories with the box under each category. **Edit** renames a category, moves a subcategory to another parent, changes the kind, or deletes it. When deleting you can move its transactions, rules and budget to another category first.

7. Categorizing: rules, unmapped transactions and overrides

A **rule** says: when a transaction's description contains (or starts with, equals, or matches a pattern) some text, put it in this category. Rules apply to past transactions and to every future import.

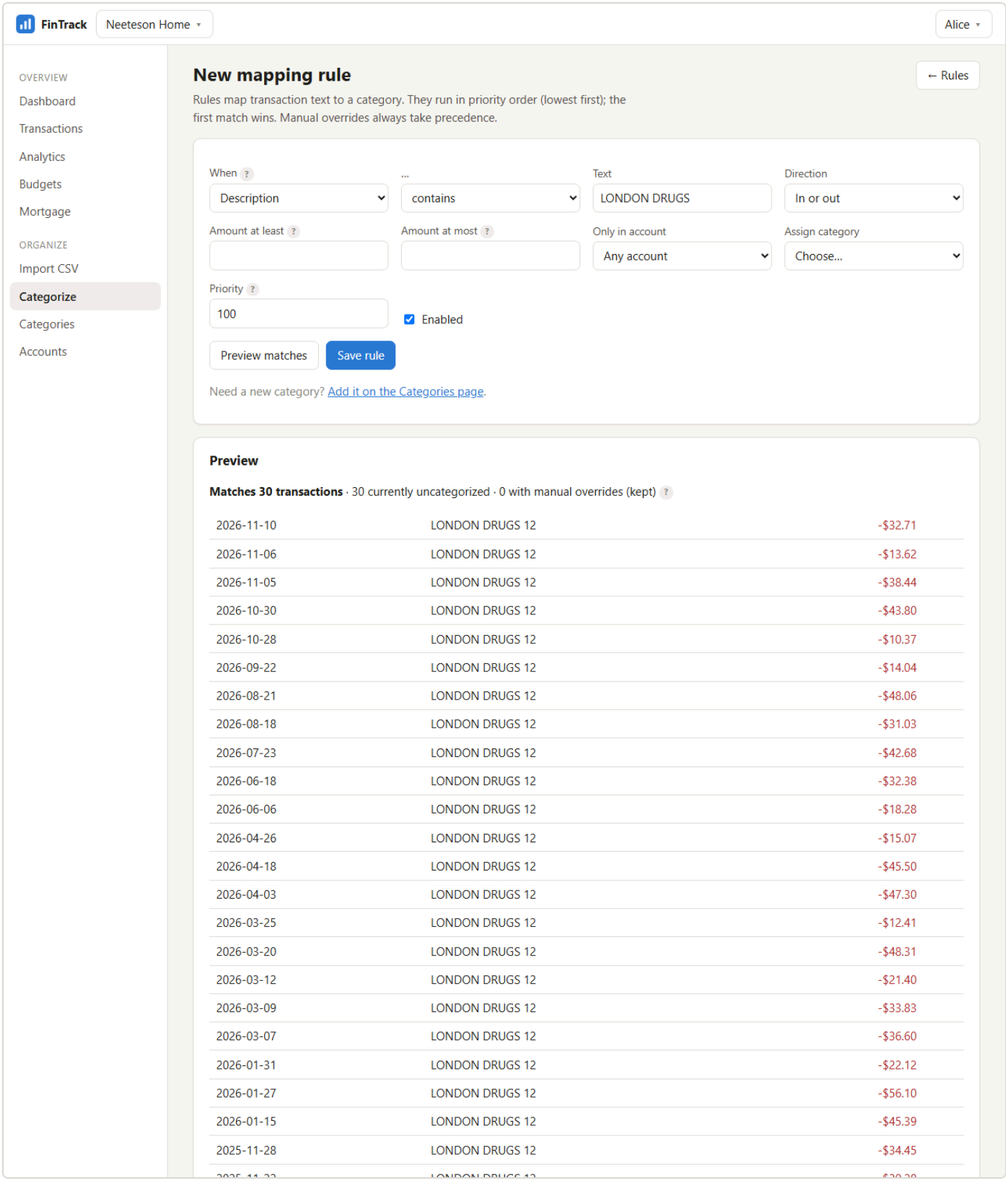


The Unmapped tab

Uncategorized transactions, grouped by payee, biggest groups first. For each group:

- **Create rule** opens the rule editor with the payee text filled in.
- **Assign once** puts just these transactions in a category, without a rule.

The rule editor



- **When**: description, memo, or either; *contains* / *starts with* / *equals* ignore upper/lower case and extra spaces; *matches regex* is for patterns.

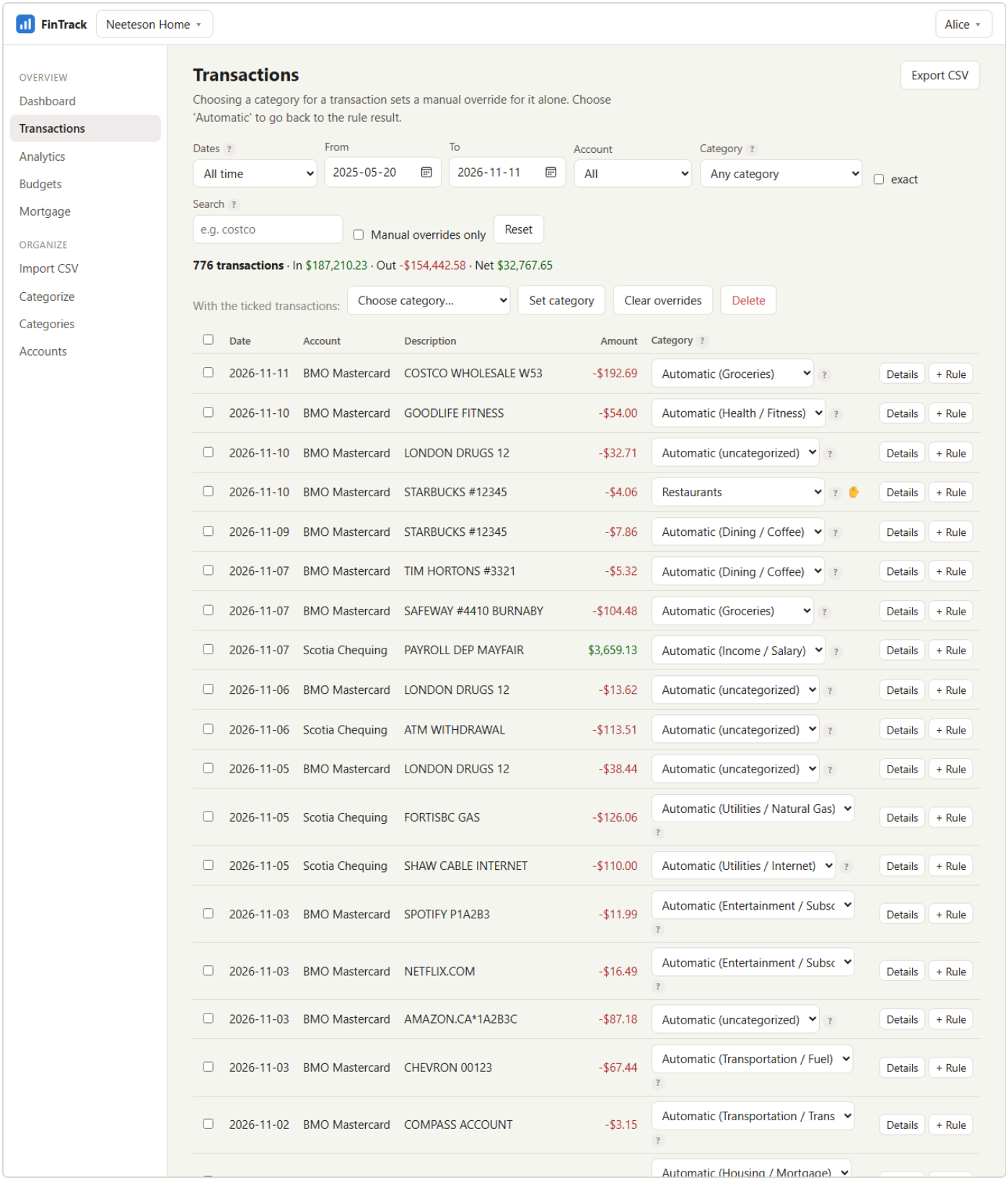
- Optional limits: money in or out only, an amount range (e.g. Costco over $200 is Household, not Groceries), one account.
- **Priority**: lower numbers run first and the first matching rule wins. Give specific rules a lower number than general ones.
- The **preview** lists every transaction the rule would catch, and updates as you type, before you save.

The **Rules** tab lists all rules with how many transactions each one categorizes, a **Test a description** box ("which rule would catch this?"), and on/off switches.

Overrides

On the Transactions page, choosing a category for a single transaction sets a **manual override** (marked ✋). Rules never change it. Choose *Automatic* to go back to the rule result.

8. Working with transactions

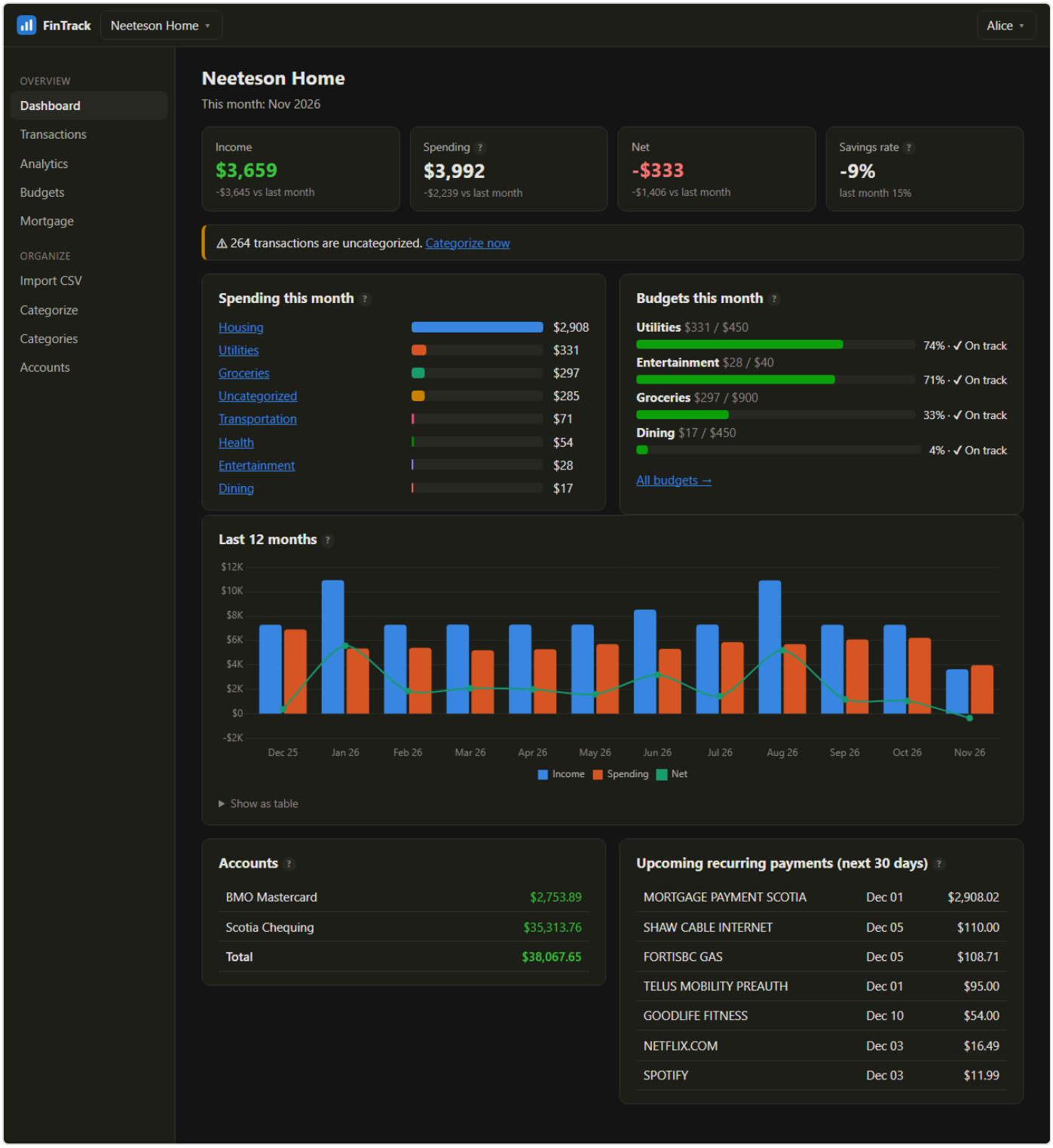


- **Filters:** date range (presets or your own dates), account, category (including *Uncategorized*; a top-level category includes its subcategories unless you tick *exact*), text search over description, memo and notes, and manual overrides only. The list updates as you change them. Press `/` to jump to the search box. The page address follows the filters, so you can bookmark a view.
- Totals in, out and net for the filtered list appear above the table.
- **Category column:** pick a category to override that transaction; it's saved straight away. The **?** shows which rule categorized it.
- **Bulk actions:** tick transactions (or the box in the header for all shown), then set a category, clear overrides, or delete.
- **Details** shows everything about a transaction and lets you add a private **note**. **+ Rule** starts a rule from that transaction.
- **Export CSV** downloads the filtered list.

9. The dashboard

The dashboard summarises the current month:

- **Income, spending, net and savings rate** compared with last month.
- A reminder if transactions are uncategorized.
- **Spending this month** by top-level category; click one to see its transactions.
- **Budgets this month**, the ones closest to their limit first.
- **Last 12 months**: income and spending bars with a net line. Hover over a month to see the amounts; click it to open that month's transactions.
- **Accounts** with today's balances, and **upcoming recurring payments** in the next 30 days.

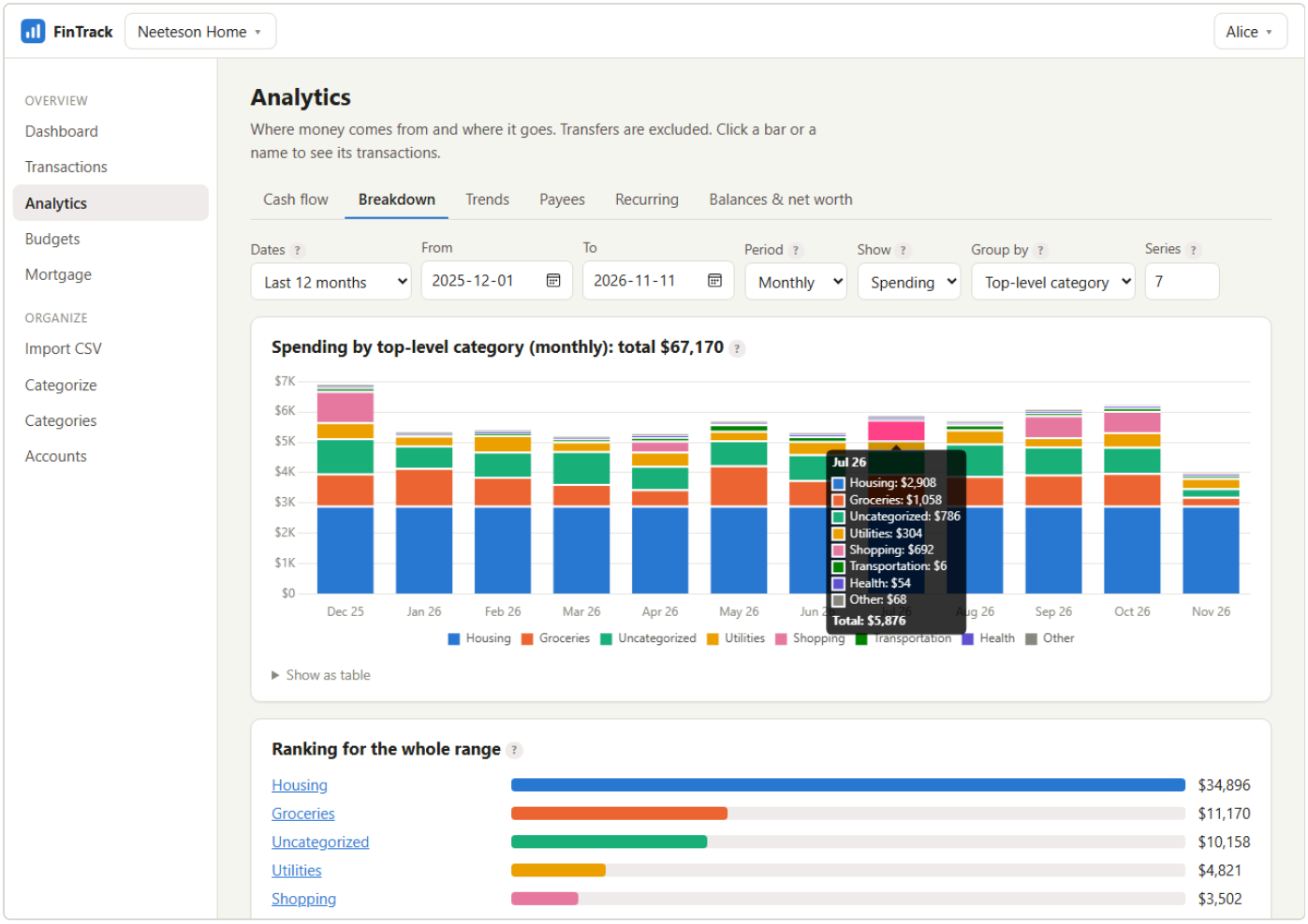


The dashboard in the dark theme.

10. Analytics

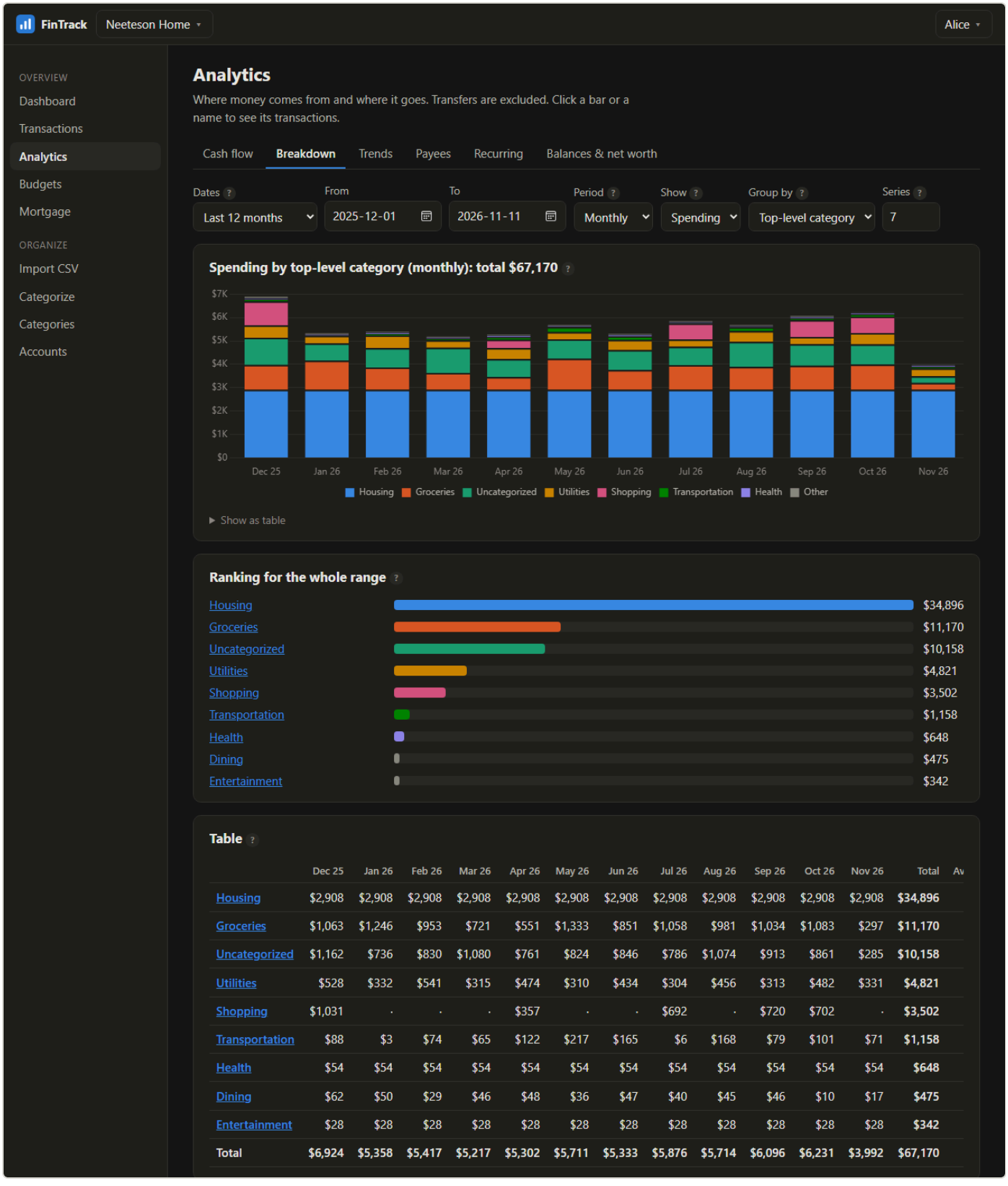
Analytics has six tabs sharing one row of controls: **dates**, **period** (weekly, monthly, quarterly, annual), **show** (spending or income) and **group by** (top-level category, subcategory, account or payee). The page updates as you change them.

> **Charts** Hover a bar or point to see every series for that period (and the total for stacked bars). Click it to open the transactions behind it. Click a legend entry to hide or show that series. *Show as table* under each chart lists the same numbers.



Hovering a month in the Breakdown chart.

Tab	Shows
Cash flow	Income vs spending per period with net and savings rate, and a table by period.
Breakdown	Stacked bars per period, a ranking for the whole range, and a table with totals, averages and shares. **Series** sets how many groups get their own colour; the rest are combined as *Other*. Click a name to see its transactions.
Trends	One group over time against its average, with highest and lowest periods.
Payees	The largest payees by total, with count, average and last date.
Recurring	Detected subscriptions and bills (regular interval and consistent amount) with their monthly and yearly cost.
Balances & net worth	Account balances over time and their total.

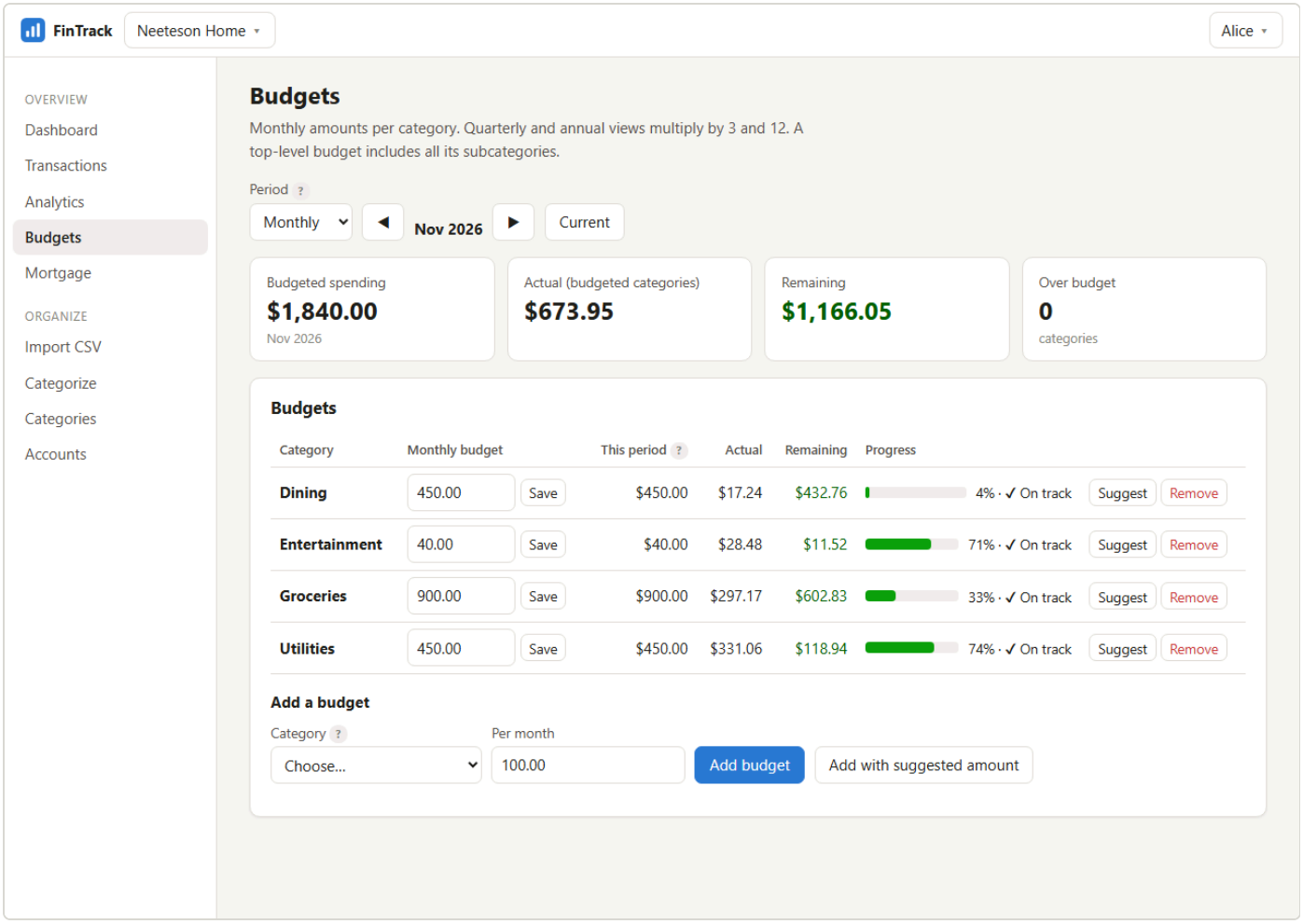


	Dec 25	Jan 26	Feb 26	Mar 26	Apr 26	May 26	Jun 26	Jul 26	Aug 26	Sep 26	Oct 26	Nov 26	Total	Av
Housing	$2,908	$2,908	$2,908	$2,908	$2,908	$2,908	$2,908	$2,908	$2,908	$2,908	$2,908	$2,908	**$34,896**	
Groceries	$1,063	$1,246	$953	$721	$551	$1,333	$851	$1,058	$981	$1,034	$1,083	$297	**$11,170**	
Uncategorized	$1,162	$736	$830	$1,080	$761	$824	$846	$786	$1,074	$913	$861	$285	**$10,158**	
Utilities	$528	$332	$541	$315	$474	$310	$434	$304	$456	$313	$482	$331	**$4,821**	
Shopping	$1,031	.	.	.	$357	.	.	$692	.	$720	$702	.	**$3,502**	
Transportation	$88	$3	$74	$65	$122	$217	$165	$6	$168	$79	$101	$71	**$1,158**	
Health	$54	$54	$54	$54	$54	$54	$54	$54	$54	$54	$54	$54	**$648**	
Dining	$62	$50	$29	$46	$48	$36	$47	$40	$45	$46	$10	$17	**$475**	
Entertainment	$28	$28	$28	$28	$28	$28	$28	$28	$28	$28	$28	$28	**$342**	
Total	**$6,924**	**$5,358**	**$5,417**	**$5,217**	**$5,302**	**$5,711**	**$5,333**	**$5,876**	**$5,714**	**$6,096**	**$6,231**	**$3,992**	**$67,170**	

Transfers are always excluded. Uncategorized transactions count as spending or income by their sign. Refunds in an expense category reduce spending.

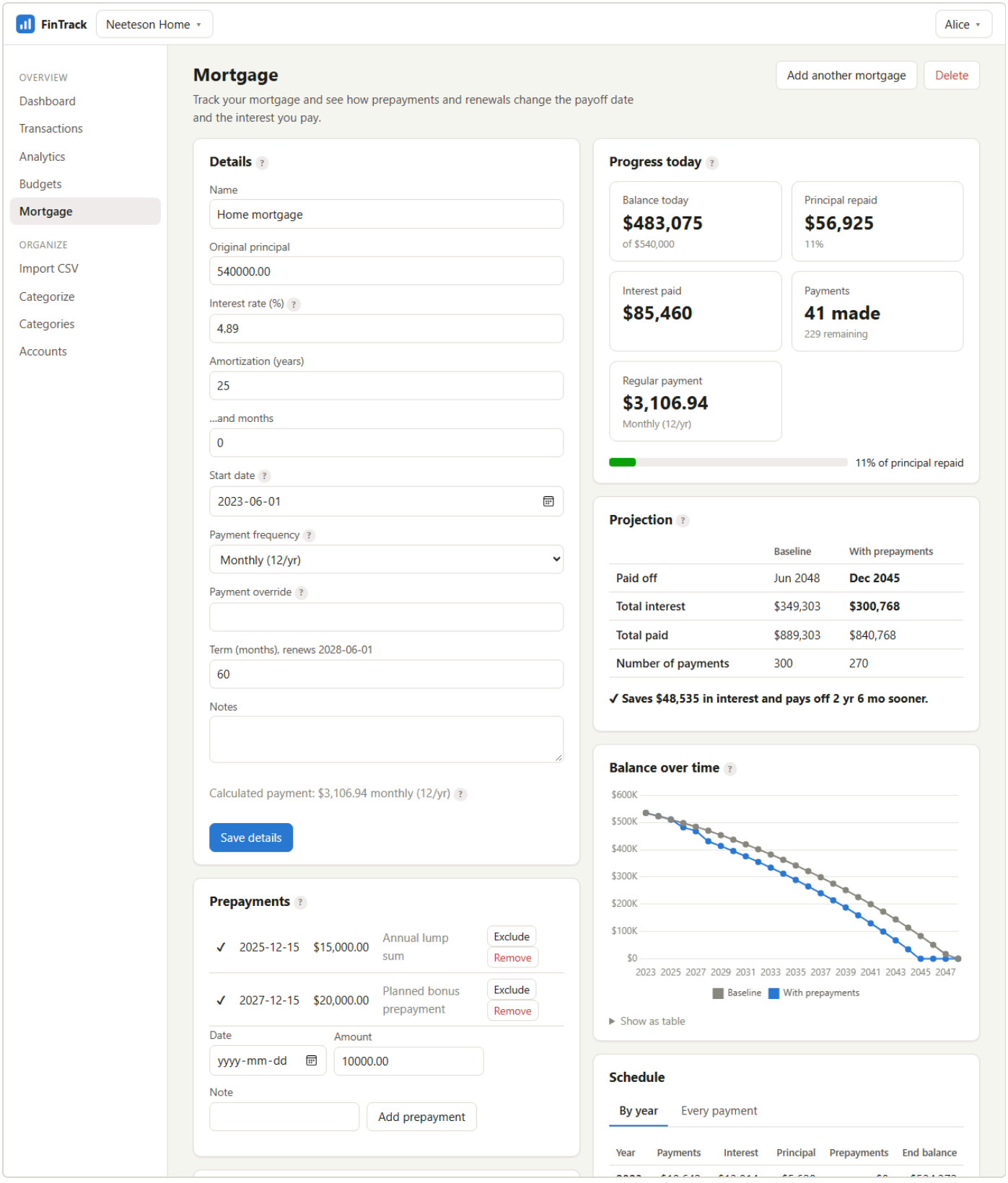
11. Budgets

Set a **monthly** amount for any category. A top-level budget includes all of its subcategories. Switch between monthly, quarterly and annual views (budgets are multiplied by 3 or 12) and step through periods with the arrows.



- Status is shown in colour *and* words: ✓ **On track** (under 85%), ⚠ **Close to limit** (85–100%), ⛔ **Over budget**.
- **Suggest** sets a budget to your average over the last three complete months.

12. Mortgage tracker



1. Click **Add mortgage** and fill in the original principal, interest rate, amortization, start date, payment frequency and term. FinTrack uses Canadian semi-annual compounding.
2. If your lender's payment differs from the calculated one, enter it as the **payment override**.
3. Add **prepayments** (date and amount), past or planned. *Exclude* one to compare scenarios without deleting it.
4. Add a **rate change** at each renewal; the payment is recalculated over the remaining amortization.

Progress today shows the balance, principal and interest paid so far. **Projection** compares the *baseline* (no prepayments) with your prepayments: payoff date, total interest, and how much interest and time you save. **What-if** adds an extra amount to every payment without saving anything. The schedule can be shown by year or by payment.

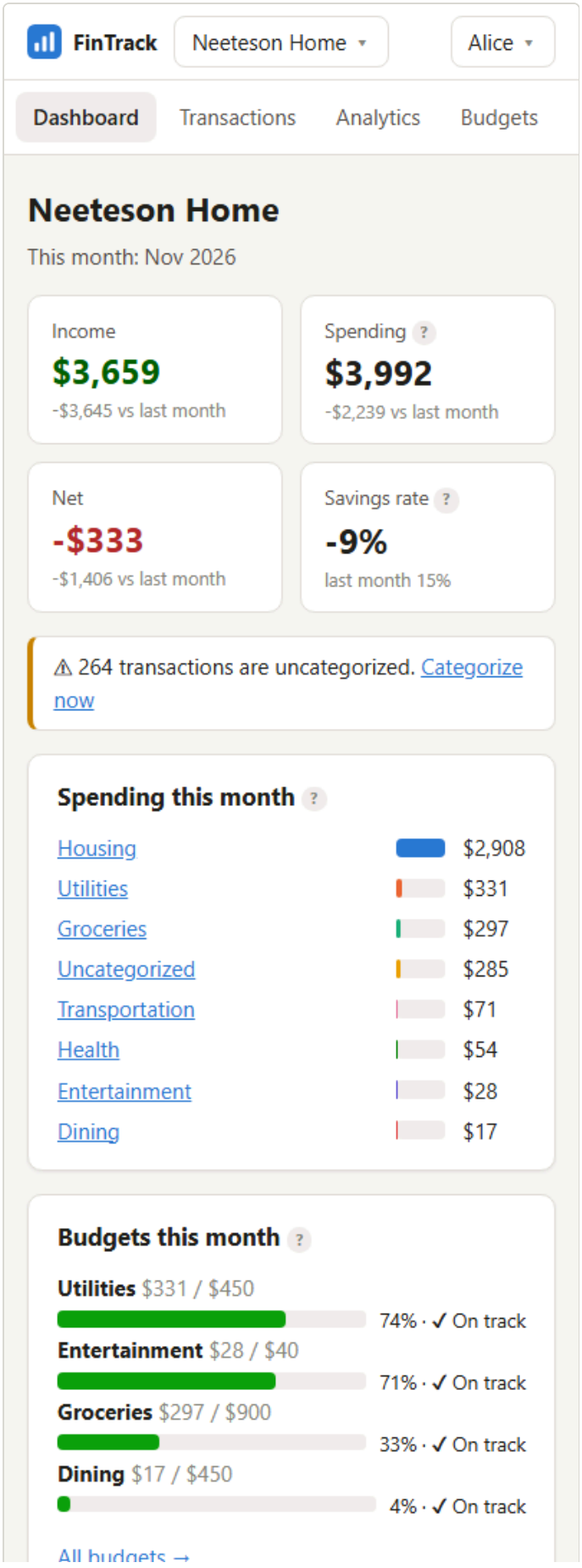
13. My account, themes and phones

Open the menu with your name and choose **My account** to:

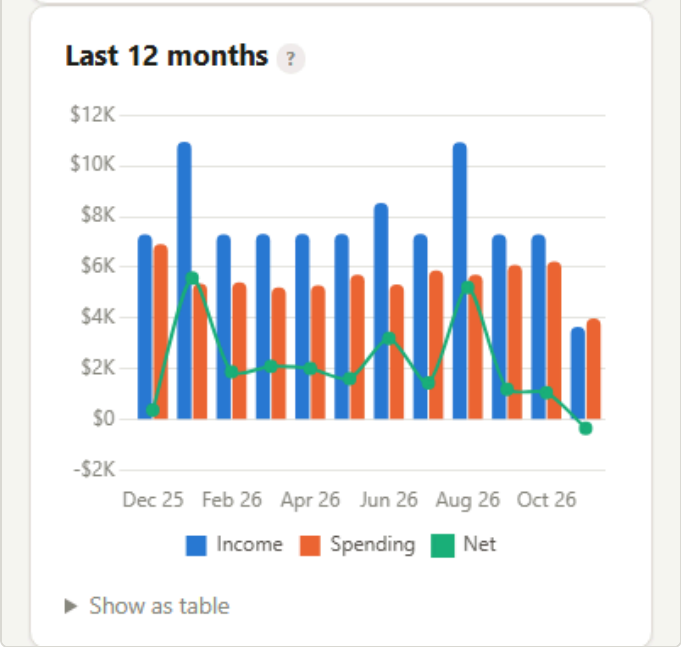
- change the name shown in the menu;
- choose the **theme**: light, dark, or match your device;
- choose which household opens when you sign in;
- change your password (this signs you out on your other devices);
- **sign out everywhere else**, e.g. after using a shared computer.

On a phone

FinTrack adapts to small screens: the side menu becomes a scrollable row of tabs, and wide tables and charts scroll sideways.


FinTrack
Neeteson Home
Alice
Dashboard
Transactions
Analytics
Budgets
Neeteson Home
This month: Nov 2026
Income
$3,659
-$3,645 vs last month
Spending
$3,992
-$2,239 vs last month
Net
-$333
-$1,406 vs last month
Savings rate
-9%
last month 15%
⚠ 264 transactions are uncategorized. Categorize now
Spending this month
Housing $2,908
Utilities $331
Groceries $297
Uncategorized $285
Transportation $71
Health $54
Entertainment $28
Dining $17
Budgets this month
Utilities $331 / $450
74% · ✓ On track
Entertainment $28 / $40
71% · ✓ On track
Groceries $297 / $900
33% · ✓ On track
Dining $17 / $450
4% · ✓ On track
All budgets →

The dashboard on a phone.



Part II
Administering FinTrack

For the person who runs the server: installing, adding people, managing households and keeping backups.

14. Installing and first-time setup

FinTrack ships as a Docker image. On the server:

```
git clone <repository> fintrack && cd fintrack
docker compose up -d --build
docker compose logs fintrack
```

Edit `compose.yaml` first if needed: `FINTRACK_BASE_PATH` is the address prefix (`/finances`), and `TZ` is your time zone.

Reverse proxy and HTTPS

FinTrack itself serves plain HTTP on port 8080. Put your reverse proxy (Caddy, nginx, Traefik) in front of it so browsers use HTTPS, and forward `/finances` to FinTrack *without* removing the prefix. Ready-made examples are in the `docker/` folder, including a compose file that adds Caddy if you have no proxy yet.

The first admin

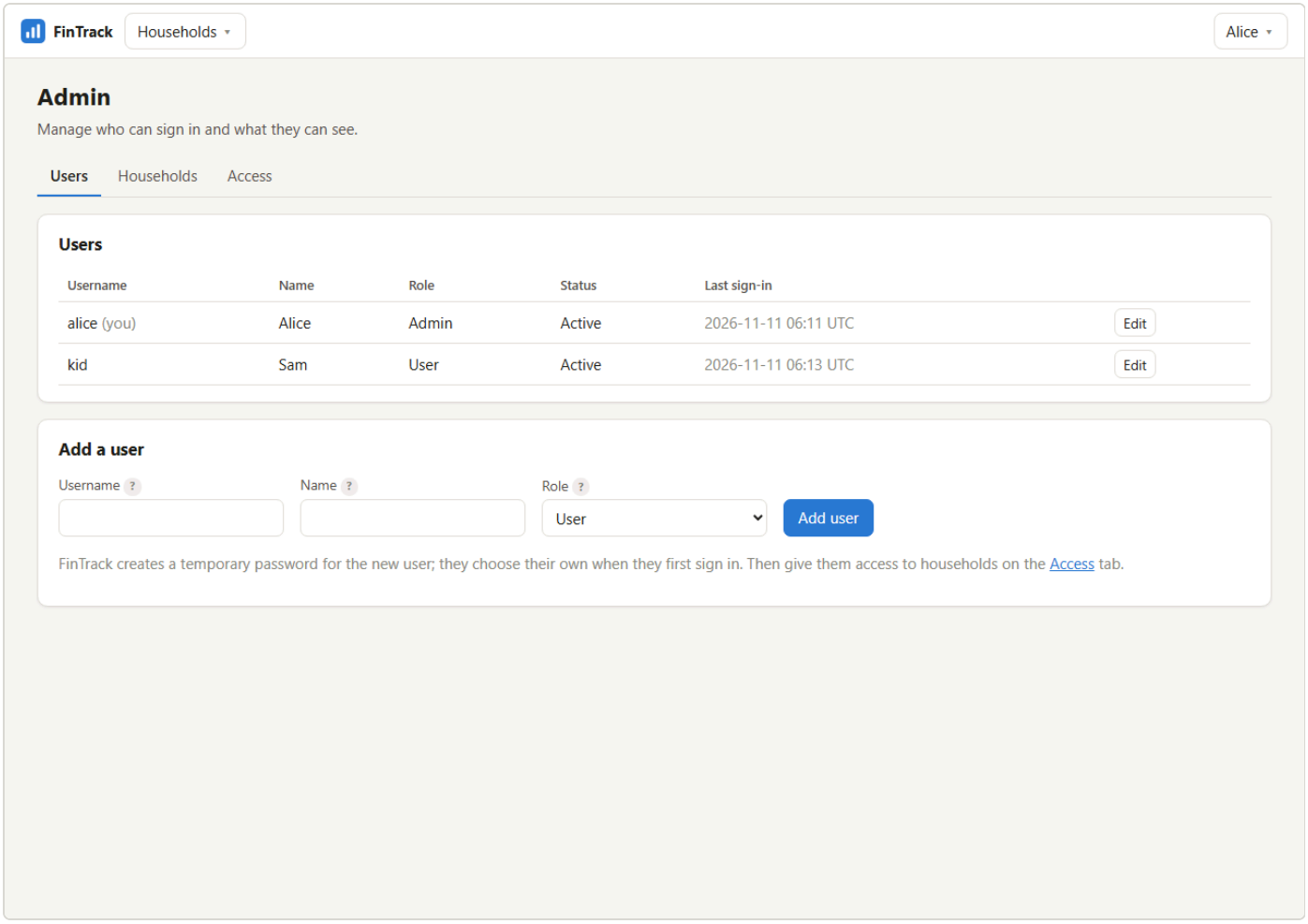
The log shows a one-time **setup link** (`/finances/setup?token=…`). Open it through your proxy and create the first admin account. The link stops working once an admin exists, so a guest on your network can't claim it. Alternatively run `docker compose exec fintrack fintrack-server admin create yourname` for a temporary password.

Updating

```
git pull
docker compose up -d --build
```

Data lives in the `fintrack-data` volume and survives updates; databases are upgraded automatically.

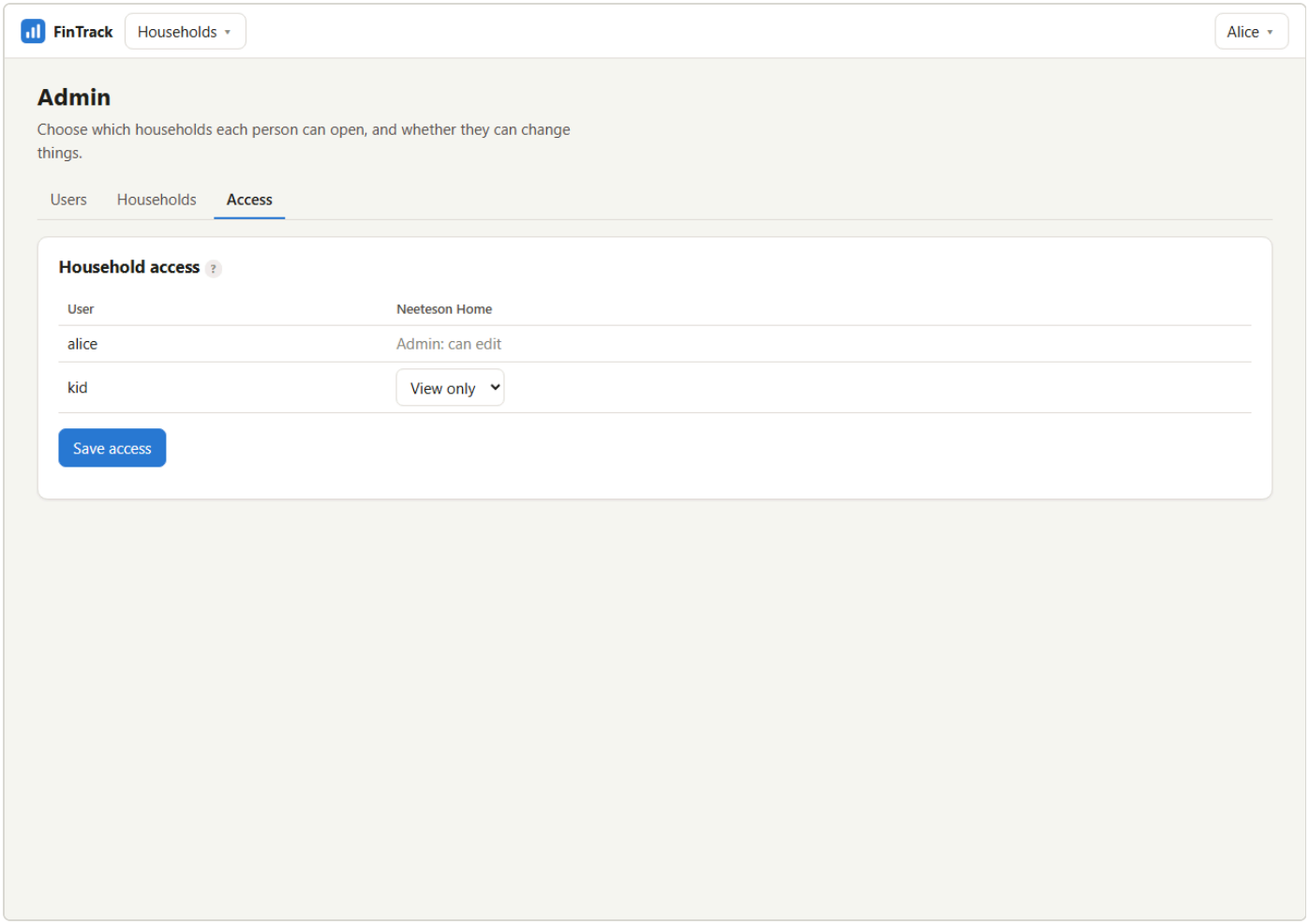
15. People and permissions



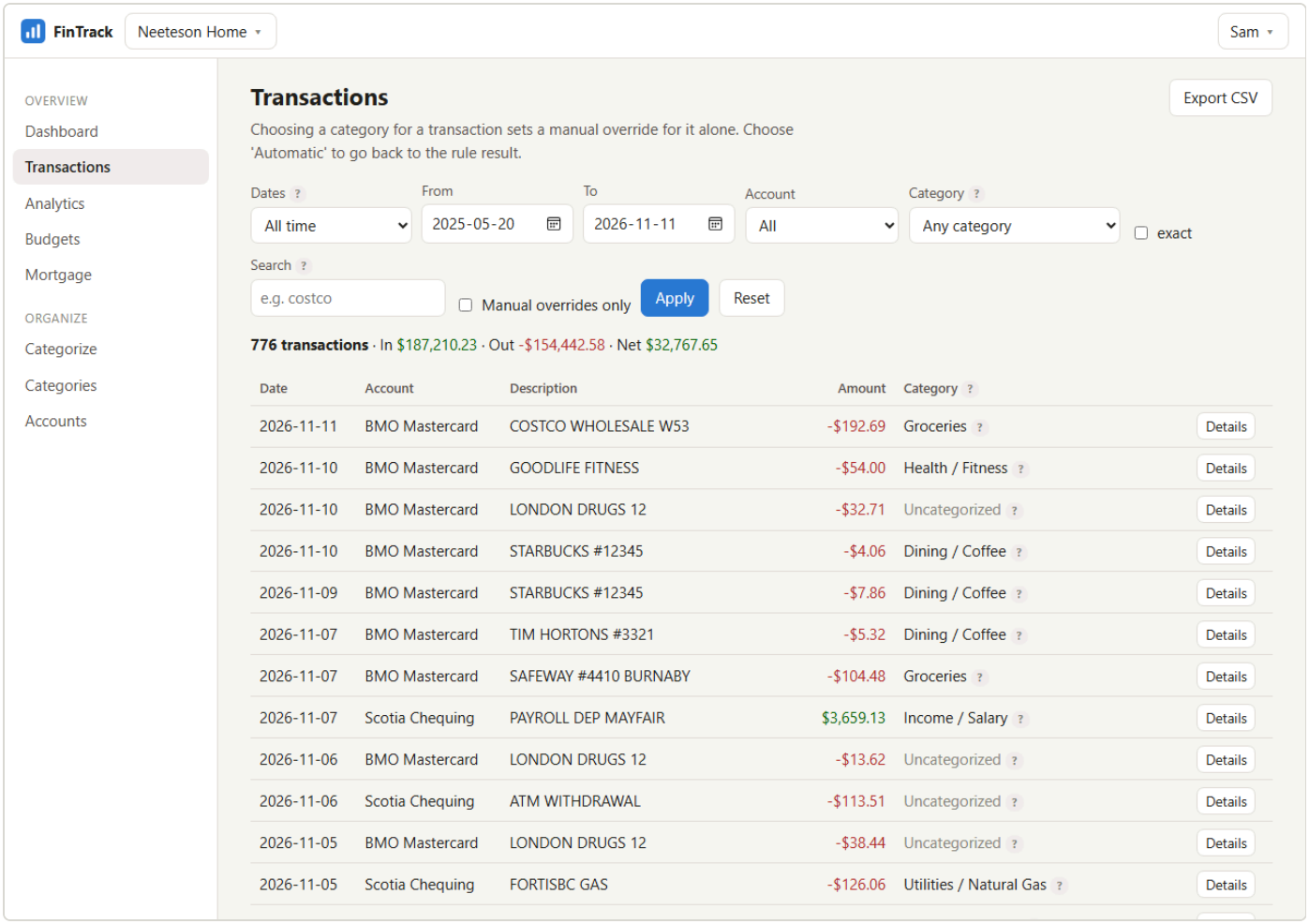
Manage users (in the menu with your name):

- **Add a user:** FinTrack shows a **temporary password**. Pass it on; they choose their own at first sign-in.
- **Edit:** rename, make an **admin**, or **disable** (blocks sign-in and signs them out everywhere). **Reset password** issues a new temporary password. **Delete** removes the account; household data is not affected.
- You can't demote, disable or delete yourself, and the last active admin can't be removed.

Access

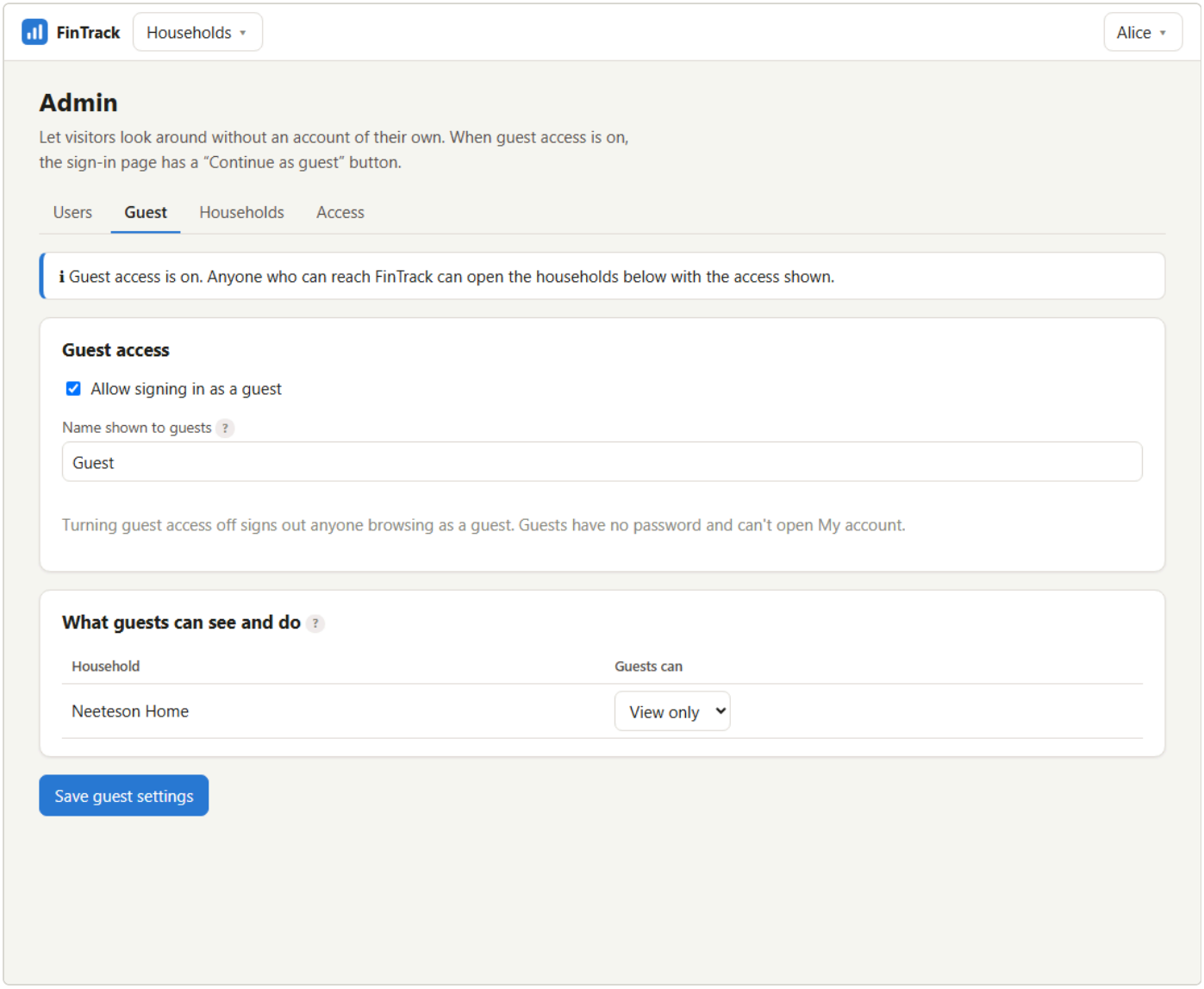


The **Access** tab is a grid of people and households. For each, choose **No access**, **View only** (dashboards, transactions, reports) or **Can edit** (also import, categorize, rules, categories, accounts, budgets, mortgage). Admins can always open and edit every household. Changes apply immediately, even to someone who is signed in.



A view-only member sees no checkboxes, category pickers or Import CSV.

Guest access



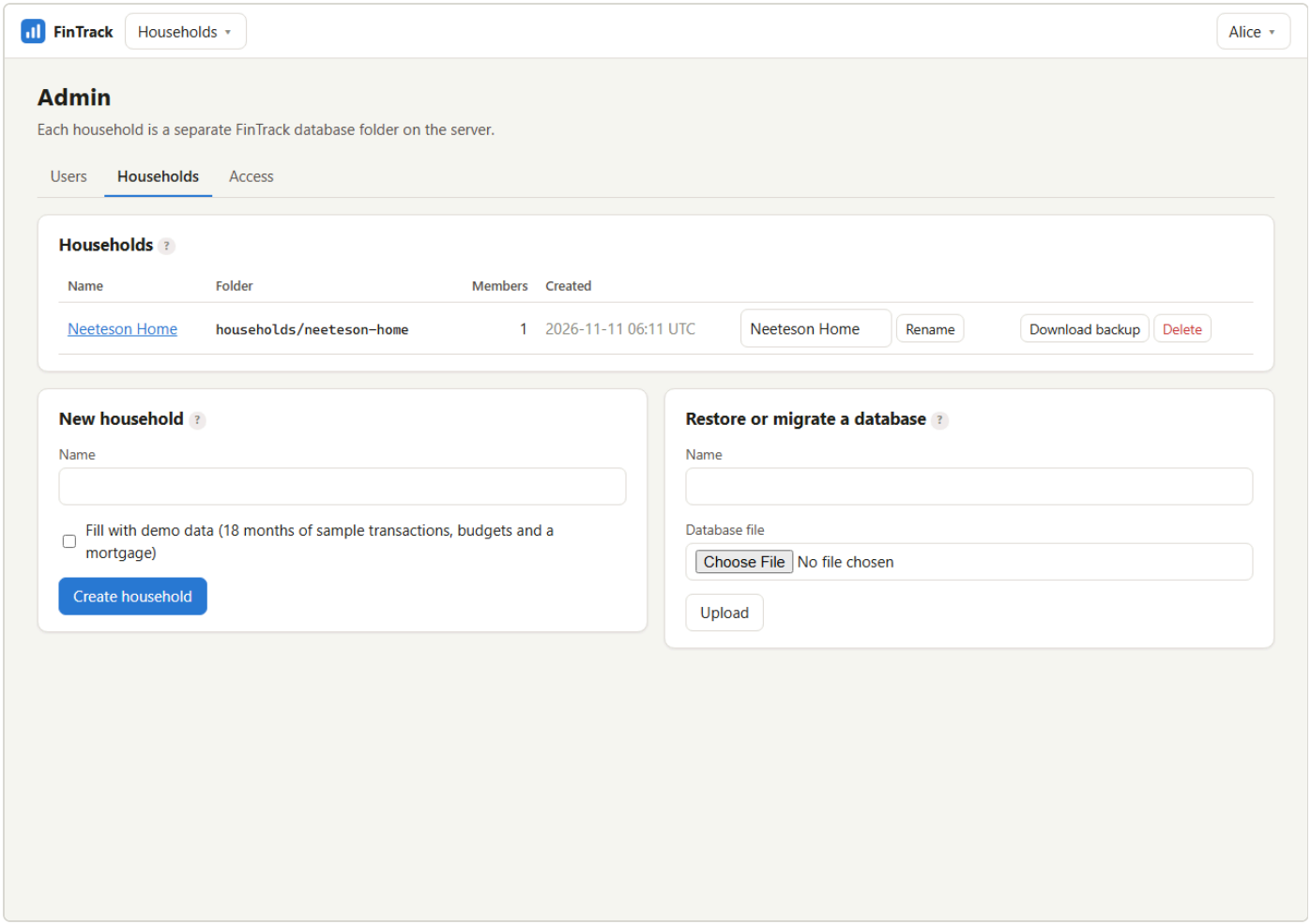
The **Guest** tab lets visitors look around without an account of their own:

- Tick **Allow signing in as a guest**. The sign-in page then shows a **Continue as guest** button.
- For each household, choose what guests can do: **No access**, **View only** or **Can edit**. The guest also appears as a row in the Access grid.
- Optionally change the name guests see in the menu.

The guest account is shared by everyone who uses the button. It has no password, can't open *My account*, and its sessions end when the browser closes. Turning guest access off signs out anyone browsing as a guest; the access settings are kept for next time.

> **Note** Anyone who can reach FinTrack on your network can use the guest button while it's on. Give guests *View only* unless you really want visitors to change things.

16. Households, backups and restoring



- **New household** starts with FinTrack's default categories. Tick **Fill with demo data** for a sample household (18 months of transactions, rules, budgets and a mortgage) to explore or to show others how FinTrack works.
- **Rename** changes the displayed name. The folder name and address stay the same.
- **Download backup** saves a consistent copy of the household's database while FinTrack keeps running. Keep these somewhere safe.
- **Restore or migrate a database** creates a household from an uploaded `fintrack.sqlite`: a downloaded backup, or the database folder of the old FinTrack desktop app.
- **Delete** moves the household's folder to `households/.trash` on the server; nothing is destroyed until you remove it there.

> **Note** Household databases are not encrypted on the server. Keep the server and your backups somewhere only you control.

17. Troubleshooting and FAQ

I sign in but end up back on the sign-in page.

The browser isn't using HTTPS, so it drops FinTrack's secure cookie. The sign-in page warns about this. Open FinTrack through your HTTPS proxy, and make sure the proxy sends `X-Forwarded-Proto`. Only if you deliberately run without HTTPS, set `FINTRACK_SECURE_COOKIES=false`.

Pages show "Not found".

You don't have access to that household, or the proxy strips the `/finances` prefix. It must forward the full path.

"Too many attempts".

Wait the number of seconds shown; the delay grows with each wrong password and resets after a successful sign-in.

The admin forgot their password.

Run `docker compose exec fintrack fintrack-server admin reset-password name`; it prints a new temporary password.

A file imported into the wrong account, or with wrong amounts.

Undo it in Import history, then import again: change the account on the review page, or use **Edit mapping** (e.g. tick *Flip sign*).

The same purchase appears twice after importing pending and posted versions.

Banks sometimes change the description when a transaction posts. Use the *skip rows* option in the format to ignore pending rows, or delete the extra transaction.

Dates like "this month" are a day off.

Set `TZ` in `compose.yaml` to your time zone.

18. Reference

Built-in CSV formats

Format	Notes
Scotiabank: bank account (classic, no header)	Five columns: date, amount, –, description, details. Recognised by its shape.
Scotiabank: credit card (classic, no header)	Three columns. Recognised by its shape.
Scotiabank: online banking export (with header)	Recognised by its header row.
BMO: bank account	Header found below BMO's preamble line; the card/account number column picks the account.
BMO: credit card	The masked card number picks the account.

Server settings

Setting	Default	Meaning
`FINTRACK_BASE_PATH`	`/`	Address prefix, e.g. `/finances`
`FINTRACK_BIND`	`0.0.0.0:8080`	Listen address
`FINTRACK_DATA_DIR`	`/data`	Where data is stored
`FINTRACK_SECURE_COOKIES`	`true`	HTTPS-only cookies
`FINTRACK_SESSION_DAYS`	`30`	"Keep me signed in" length
`FINTRACK_MAX_UPLOAD_MB`	`50`	Largest upload
`FINTRACK_ADMIN_USER` / `_PASSWORD`	unset	Create the first admin at start-up
`TZ`	`UTC`	Time zone

Commands

Command	What it does
`fintrack-server admin create NAME`	New admin with a temporary password
`fintrack-server admin reset-password NAME`	New temporary password
`fintrack-server admin list`	List accounts
`fintrack-server healthcheck`	Exit 0 if the server answers

Where data lives

`/data/auth.sqlite` holds people, households, access and sessions. Each household is a folder in `/data/households/` with `fintrack.sqlite` and an `imports/` folder holding a copy of every imported CSV.